Usiri Marketplace — group meeting pack

Purpose: decide whether to fund a bounded research phase **Date:** to be set (allow 90 minutes) **Status:** Concept under investigation. No Usiri partnership, franchise, licence, funding or integration exists. **Pre-reading:** Concept document (Sections 1, 9, 14, 15, 19), one-page executive summary, workbook, four diagrams.

1. The decision on the table

The group is not being asked to approve a launch, a franchise fee or a partnership. It is being asked to choose one of four options:

Option	What it means	Commitment
A. Fund research (recommended)	Approve Phase 2: 8 weeks, TZS 2–5m cap, named owners, written go/no-go	Time and a small budget
B. Revise and return	Narrow the segment, budget or scope, then meet again	Time only
C. Pause	Take no action now; keep the document	None
D. Stop	Record the decision and close the project	None

A decision is valid only if it names an owner, a budget cap and a date. “Let’s think about it” is not a decision.

2. Agenda (90 minutes)

Time	Item	Lead	Desired output
0–5	Welcome, purpose, decision sought	Chair	Everyone knows why we are here
5–15	The customer problem and the proposed answer	Project initiator	Shared understanding in plain language
15–30	Business model and unit economics	Finance lead	Agreement on contribution and break-even
30–45	What we know and do not know about Usiri	Project initiator	Realistic expectations; no assumptions
45–60	Risks, feasibility and what would kill the idea	COO	Top five risks agreed
60–75	Options and decision matrix	Chair	Scores and preferred option
75–85	Budget, owners, dates	Chair	Named owners and cap
85–90	Decision record and next meeting	Chair	Written decision

Meeting rules: one conversation at a time; disagree with the idea, not the person; record dissent; no decisions without an owner; phones away.

3. Five-minute context brief

The project proposes a curated marketplace for home, kitchen and small electrical goods in Dar es Salaam. Verified shops list products; the platform collects payment through a licensed provider, coordinates delivery through a licensed carrier, handles returns and stands behind the order. It is asset-light: no stock, no warehouse, no fleet at pilot.

The model earns an 8% commission (to be tested at 6–12%), a supplier subscription, a delivery coordination fee and, later, sponsored placement. At an assumed TZS 75,000 average order, contribution is about **TZS 3,730 per order**. A moderate cost structure needs about **1,206 orders a month** to break even; the pilot target is 900. At 1,000 orders the moderate structure loses about **TZS 770,000 a month**.

Usiri is a possible carrier and brand partner. It has not been approached, has not agreed to anything, and publishes no API, rate card or liability terms. The plan is designed to work without it.

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4. Financial snapshot

Item	Lean	Moderate	Ambitious
One-time startup cost	TZS 16.79m	TZS 66.36m	TZS 167.9m
Monthly fixed opex	TZS 2.2m	TZS 5.6m	TZS 12.0m
Break-even orders/month	295	1,206	2,922
Orders/day	10	40	97
12-month funding incl. 10% buffer	TZS 31.17m	TZS 129.75m	TZS 324.89m

Read this carefully: the moderate one-time cost includes a **TZS 15m placeholder** for a brand/franchise fee that has not been quoted. The ambitious figure includes a **TZS 50m placeholder**. Remove the placeholder and the moderate one-time cost falls to about TZS 51.4m. The fee may be zero, negotiable, or unaffordable; it is not a fact.

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5. Decision matrix

Instructions

1. Agree the weights **before** scoring. The proposed weights are below.
2. Each participant scores privately from 1 (very poor) to 5 (very strong).
3. Discuss the two lowest and two highest scores.
4. Re-score once, then calculate the weighted average.
5. Record the result and any dissent.

Criterion	Weight	Question to ask	Score (1–5)	Weighted
Commercial attractiveness	25%	Is the customer problem large and urgent? Will they pay?		
Feasibility	20%	Can this team build and operate the MVP?		

Criterion	Weight	Question to ask	Score (1–5)	Weighted
Cost and funding	15%	Is it affordable, with a credible path to break-even?		
Risk	20%	Is the downside acceptable, including partner dependence?		
Strategic fit	10%	Does it fit our skills, network and ambitions?		
Evidence quality	10%	Do we have enough evidence to proceed?		
Total	**100%**			**/5**

Interpretation (agree before scoring):

- **4.0–5.0:** proceed to Phase 2 with confidence.
- **3.0–3.9:** proceed, but fix the weakest criterion first.
- **2.0–2.9:** revise the concept and reassess.
- **Below 2.0:** stop or pivot.

Warning: do not score evidence quality highly because the concept document is long. It is desk research. There are no customer, supplier or carrier interviews yet.

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6. Discussion questions

Use these to structure the conversation, not to fill time.

Customer

1. Which specific customer are we serving, and what do they buy today?
2. Would we use this service ourselves? What would stop us?
3. What would make a first-time buyer trust us with TZS 75,000?
4. Is a TZS 5,000–7,000 delivery charge realistic, or must it be absorbed?

Supplier

1. Which five shops would we approach first, and why would they say yes?
2. What commission would make them refuse?
3. Can they pack to a standard, and who trains them?
4. What happens when a supplier cancels or sends the wrong item?

Partner

1. What exactly do we want from Usiri: carriage, brand, branches, or all three?
2. What are we willing to give in return?
3. What is our walk-away condition?
4. If Usiri says no, do we still proceed? (The answer should be yes.)

Money and team

1. How much can the group afford to lose?
2. Who funds the research phase, and on what terms?
3. What evidence would justify the next tranche?
4. Who is accountable for each phase, and what happens if a founder leaves?

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7. Usiri preparation checklist

Do not leave the meeting without agreeing who will lead the Usiri conversation and what they may say.

What we may say

- We are exploring a marketplace concept and would like to understand your parcel services.
- We are interested in a possible carrier agreement, and possibly a brand licence, but nothing is agreed.
- We will not use your name publicly without written permission.
- We would like a written rate card, service level and liability terms.

What we must not say

- “Usiri is partnering with us.”
- “We have Usiri’s approval.”
- “We will guarantee you X parcels.”
- “We can pay a franchise fee” (before the group has approved it).
- “We will use your brand” (before a licence is signed).

What to request in writing

1. Legal entity, registration and TIN.
2. Routes, transit times and parcel limits.
3. Rate card, volumetric weight, surcharges and minimums.
4. Liability limit, claims process and insurance.
5. Tracking and proof of delivery.
6. Capacity and peak-season constraints.
7. Payment and reconciliation terms.
8. Termination and wind-down.
9. Data-sharing and PDPA roles.
10. Brand licence interest and any fee expectation.

Walk-away conditions

- Exclusive commitment without volume guarantees.
- Upfront franchise fee before a pilot.
- Liability cap below parcel value with no insurance.
- No written service level.
- Rates revised after onboarding.
- Multi-year lock-in.

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8. Evidence checklist before the next gate

The research phase must produce these. Tick them off as they are completed.

#	Evidence	Owner	Due	Status
1	30 customer interviews, recorded themes	CEO	Week 8	☐
2	150+ survey responses on price and delivery	Growth	Week 8	☐
3	15 supplier interviews with commission indications	COO	Week 8	☐
4	5 supplier site visits and verification checks	COO	Week 8	☐
5	8 competitor mystery shops with screenshots	Growth	Week 6	☐
6	3 written carrier rate cards	CEO	Week 8	☐
7	Draft carrier SLA and liability terms	CEO	Week 8	☐
8	Usiri meeting notes and written follow-up	CEO	Week 6	☐
9	Legal briefing on company, PDPA, FCC, payments	Finance	Week 8	☐
10	Accounting note on VAT, CIT, withholding	Finance	Week 8	☐
11	Re-run financial model with real data	Finance	Week 8	☐
12	Written go/no-go recommendation	CEO	Week 9	☐

9. Budget for the research phase

Item	Low (TZS)	High (TZS)	Notes
Transport for interviews and shop visits	400,000	900,000	Fuel, fares, parking
Participant incentives	300,000	800,000	Airtime or small vouchers; disclose
Survey tooling and SMS	100,000	300,000	Short code or online panel
Legal briefing	800,000	2,000,000	Fixed-scope opinion
Accounting briefing	300,000	800,000	Tax and registration
Printing, calls, miscellaneous	100,000	200,000	
Total	**2,000,000**	**5,000,000**	Cap to be approved

The research budget is separate from the startup budget in Section 15. It should be released in two tranches: 50% at approval, 50% after a two-week progress check.

10. Owners and dates

Role	Name	Responsibility	Deadline
Chair		Runs the meeting; signs the decision record	Meeting day
Research lead		Phase 2 plan, interviews, synthesis	Week 8
Supplier lead		Supplier interviews and verification	Week 8
Carrier lead		Carrier quotes and Usiri meeting	Week 8
Finance lead		Budget, model, legal/accounting briefs	Week 8
Technical lead		MVP scoping and build estimate	Week 6
Note-taker		Minutes and decision record	48 hours after meeting

If a role is unfilled, the group must decide whether to recruit, outsource or reduce scope. An unfilled role is a risk, not a detail.

11. Decision record

Item	Record
Date and attendees	
Decision	A / B / C / D
Budget cap	TZS
Scope	
Owners	
Deadline	
Conditions	
Dissenting views	
Next review date	

Signatures (or written assent):

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12. What not to decide today

- Do not approve a launch.
- Do not authorise a franchise fee or deposit.

- Do not promise Usiri anything.
- Do not allocate equity without a written agreement.
- Do not set a public launch date.
- Do not treat a verbal expression of interest as a partnership.
- Do not raise money on untested projections.

13. Next 30 days if Option A is chosen

Week	Action	Owner
1	Open project folder, budget tracker and weekly meeting	Research lead
1	Draft interview guides and survey	Research lead
1	List 60 target suppliers and 10 carriers	Supplier/carrier leads
2	Start customer interviews; request carrier quotes	Research lead
2	Open legal and accounting briefs	Finance lead
3	Complete 10 customer and 5 supplier interviews	Team
3	Meet Usiri; send written summary	Carrier lead
4	Interim findings memo; review budget	Research lead
4	Decide whether to continue to weeks 5–8	Chair

This pack is a facilitation tool. It does not create any obligation on the group, Usiri or any third party. All figures are planning assumptions.